FAST 4+1 B.A./M.A. roadmap: both degrees in five years

First-year entry, ten semesters · Graduate Coordinator: Inés Thiebaut, ines.thiebaut@csueastbay.edu, (510) 885-3126

This roadmap online

Degrees	Entry	Total	Catalog
B.A. and M.A. in Music	First-year, fall B (odd years)	120 + 32 units, 12 shared	2027–2028

01 Degrees at a glance

Degree	Units
B.A. in Music	
Music, including 12 blended	54
General education	48
Free electives*	18
B.A. total	**120**
M.A. in Music	
Blended, counting toward both degrees	12
5th year graduate coursework	20
M.A. total	**32**

*These vary depending on each student's path through the GE requirements and free electives, up to 120 units.

02 The five years

The first three years follow the B.A. roadmap. Students apply to FAST in the junior year. In the fourth year, they complete the B.A. alongside the first two semesters of the M.A., and the fifth year is graduate study only.

M.A. emphases are Performance (Classical or Jazz), Choral Conducting, and Composition. The GE courses shown are one typical selection. Students build their own GE plan with an advisor.

String players take Chamber Orchestra (MUS 365) as their Major Performing Ensemble.

03 Semester by semester

Music · General education · Counts toward both degrees

Lower division

First semester (fall B)

Course	Title	Units
ENGL 100	College Writing: Stretch I	3
ENGL 109	College Writing Lab	1
ES 121	People's History I	3
HIST 110	United States to 1877	3
MUS 108	The Language of Music	3
MUS 261–269	Applied Music Study (applied area placement)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
	Semester total	**15**

Second semester (spring B)

Course	Title	Units
ENGL 101	College Writing: Stretch II	2
ENGL 109	College Writing Lab	1
COMM 100	Oral Communication	3
MATH 118E	Mathematics for the Arts and Humanities	4
MUS 111	Music Theory I	2
MUS 115	Aural Skills I	1
MUS 118	Keyboard Musicianship I	1
MUS 261–269	Applied Music Study	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
	Semester total	**16**

Third semester (fall A)

Course	Title	Units
PHIL 100	Critical Thinking	3
GE 3B	Humanities	3
GE 5A	Physical and Biological Sciences	3
MUS 112	Music Theory II	2
MUS 116	Aural Skills II	1
MUS 119	Keyboard Musicianship II	1
MUS 381	Essentials of Music Technology	3
MUS 261–269	Applied Music Study	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
	Semester total	**18**

Upper division

Fifth semester (fall B)

Course	Title	Units
UD GE 4	Upper-division Social and Behavioral Sciences	3
MUS 304	World Music & Culture	3
MUS 410	20th and 21st C Styles and Techniques	3
MUS 461–469	Applied Music Study (jury)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
	Free electives	4
	Semester total	**15**

Fourth semester (spring A)

Course	Title	Units
GE 5B–C	Physical and Biological Sciences with lab	4
GE 6	Ethnic Studies	3
MUS 202	Writing About Music	3
MUS 211	Music Theory III	2
MUS 215	Aural Skills III	1
MUS 218	Keyboard Musicianship III	1
MUS 261–269	Applied Music Study	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
	Semester total	**16**

Sixth semester (spring B)

Course	Title	Units
UD GE 5	Upper-division Science and Quantitative Reasoning	3
UWR	University Writing Requirement	3
MUS 461–469	Applied Music Study (jury)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
	Free electives	6
	Semester total	**14**

Students apply to FAST by the end of week 7 of the sixth semester and begin FAST coursework the following semester.

Blended year: the last of the B.A. alongside the first of the M.A.

Seventh semester (fall A) · M.A. first semester

Course	Title	Units
MUS 323	Topics in Western Music History	3
MUS 312	Form and Analysis	3
MUS 360–369	Chamber Ensemble	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
MUS 661–668	Graduate Applied Study (jury)	2
MUS 601	Analysis of Musical Styles: Birth and Death of Tonality	2
MUS 603	Entrepreneurship in the Arts	2
	Counts toward the B.A.	14
	Counts toward the M.A.	6
	Semester total	**14**

Eighth semester (spring A) · M.A. second semester

Course	Title	Units
MUS 324	History of American Music	3
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
	Free electives	2
MUS 661–668	Graduate Applied Study (jury)	2
MUS 605	History and Theory of Jazz	2
MUS 606	Interdisciplinary Collaboration in Music	2
	Counts toward the B.A.	12
	Counts toward the M.A.	6
	Semester total	**12**

The B.A. is complete at 120 units.

Graduate year

M.A. third semester (fall B)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 602	Analysis of Musical Styles: Post-Tonality and Beyond	2
MUS 630	Advanced Conducting	2
MUS 661–668	Graduate Applied Study (jury)	2
MUS 351–355, 360–369	Ensemble(s)	2
MUS 693	Capstone, 1 of 2	2
	Semester total	**10**

M.A. fourth semester (spring B)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 604	Sounding Justice: Unveiling the Ecological and Social Dimensions of Music	2
MUS 631	Teaching Music in Higher Education	2
MUS 661–668	Graduate Applied Study (jury)	2
MUS 351–355, 360–369	Ensemble(s)	2
MUS 693	Capstone, 2 of 2	2
	Semester total	**10**

The M.A. is complete at 32 units.